

LF Word Form Flexibility

WHAT THIS SKILL MEANS

Most ideas can be expressed as a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb, depending on what the sentence needs. If you always say “decide” and never “decision” or “decisive,” you’ll eventually hit a sentence where “decide” doesn’t fit — and get stuck. Strong speakers shift the form of a word to match the grammar of the sentence, not the other way around.

WHAT TO TRY

- When you reach for the same word repeatedly, ask if a different form fits better
- Practice converting verbs you know well into noun form, and back again
- If a sentence feels awkward, check whether you’re forcing the wrong word form into the slot
- Build pairs you’re confident with: decide/decision, react/reaction, succeed/success

SENTENCE STARTERS

- “The decision to do this was difficult, but deciding quickly mattered more.”
- “Their reluctance reflects a deeper concern...”
- “This requires not just acting, but a decisive approach.”

EXAMPLE IN ACTION

The decision to regulate social media algorithms is difficult, but deciding too slowly creates its own risk. A decisive policy now could prevent a much larger problem later — the kind of decisiveness that’s hard to achieve once public opinion is already divided. Decide, deciding, decisive, and decisiveness all come from the same root, but each one fits a different slot in the sentence.